
ANOVEL

SHE SAW IN COLOR

PROLOGUE

*A war is being waged for humanity — for
those who dare to see.*

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The city was on fire, and it was beautiful.

Each stone in the sidewalk, the patch of dandelions up ahead, the glint of the nearby mailbox—, all blazed with the spirit of life. Every atom burned with the boldest of colors that could warm even the coldest of souls.

How could anyone turn against it? Despite centuries of service and access to banks of wisdom beyond comprehension, I, Joseph, still struggle to crack the simple question. Perhaps I wasn't born with that type of empathy.

Fun fact! Deets and Joseph are named after my two brothers

With his wings tucked, my new partner strolled to my left almost painfully slow. Though we just met, I did my due diligence. His file didn't share too much, but his name was Deets, and he was mostly described as enthusiastic — which, I had learned over the years, could mean almost anything. But there was no point in asking questions now. Soon enough, we'd be on our next assignment, and I'd have a whole human lifespan to figure it out.

As the sidewalk turned into a dirt path, the oaks and pines became denser, and the commotion of the city lightened up. I took a deep breath and filled my lungs with air, so crisp it was nearly intoxicating.

Up ahead, the trees opened into a clearing. On the crest of the hill stood a singular magnolia tree, ancient and grandiose, its canopy spread wide against the sky. The awe of the spectacle kept me from blinking until my eyes stung with dryness.

A humble yet elegant cottage was nestled in its mature limbs. The oak paneling was warm and medium-toned, the dark slate shingles a deliberate contrast to the wooden finish below, which caught the light as if there were a spotlight on the whole structure.

A rope ladder dangled from the small porch overhead, swaying in the wind. Deets reached for it without hesitation, talons wrapping around the first rung. I spread my wings and flew straight up to the landing.

Then, the tree house door swung inward. Revealed to us was our master: Iradel, Author of Reality.

His stature commanded attention — not in a demanding way, but in a manner so lovely you couldn't take your eyes off him.

He held a brightness that was woven in the elevated muscles of his countenance and his relaxed but lifted shoulders.

Gentleness whispered through his soft smile before even a word left his mouth. He was a kind of brilliance that spoke to your core, something beyond what any vocabulary could reach. He wore a plain navy t-shirt and straight-legged jeans, accenting his lean figure.

“Joseph. Deets.” He met us with blazing brown eyes that held the mystery of the universe.

Though I may not be good at it, I believe all beings are designed to experience rest. It was important to portray this through my “spiritual guardians.”

In sync, we lowered our torsos into a bow. “It's always a pleasure to be in your presence,” I said.

“Welcome back. I trust you both had a good sabbatical,” Iradel said.

Sabbatical was a special time, much needed between the demands of assignments, and it's hard to believe how quickly those seven years can fly by.

Iradel took a step back, taking his hand out of his pocket to usher us in. As we followed, the scent of old wood and ink filled my nose. The space was just as I'd remembered — modest for its significance, yet elegant in design. Light streamed in from the windows, highlighting intricate nature patterns carved into the shelves, chairs, and most importantly, the writing desk.

My heart skipped a beat just looking at the finished wood and docked quill pen. This is where it all began. Iradel took a few graceful steps toward it, his skin almost the same shade as the brown wood, thumbing through the papers strewn across his desk.

“Ahh, here it is.” He pulled out a stack of parchment bound together with a paperclip. “Please,” he panned to the chairs across from him.

After taking our seats on the leather upholstery, Iradel cleanly flipped over the first page. I craned my neck, trying to read the handwritten script, but it was in a language even I couldn't read. Page after page was filled to the brim with notes, diagrams, and light drawings. Even the margins had scribbles.

"I'm honored to present your next assignment." Iradel lifted his poised, kind eyes as if he had the most interesting news in the world to share. And perhaps, every assignment was exactly that. He continued, "She will --"

"It's a girl!" Deets blurted out, pedaling his wiry feet.

Iradel shook his head in approval of his own creation. "Yes, indeed. She's a complicated girl who loves simple things. Not an easy job by any means."

As Iradel read from the parchment, the script on the page morphed from blank ink to pure gold. Every word was delicately and precisely selected after years of refining.

I straightened my shoulders as I took it all in. How many early mornings and late nights did he put into this singular being? How many intricacies, details, and hidden gems will be unfolded over time? The care Iradel put into his craft was truly remarkable.

And to think we were just participating in a sliver of it. The wall behind Iradel was filled with dozens of other pages that were all "works in progress."

"Her heart precedes her," he continued, completely consumed by his creation. "She's eager, like a soldier dressed in armor that was a bit loose because she hadn't quite grown into it yet, and was the first to run into the valley ahead of the rest of the line."

"She sets her dreams to sail in the air like a kite and then chases them down with every fiber of her being. Her bold heart is ever youthful, and she sees with great depth. At her core, she's a healer."

Then, poised and collected, Iradel leaned in.

"But as you know, to see with great depth is a double-edged sword. It's an honor to experience so much humanity, but it comes with its own burdens to bear and power to be used wisely. Confusion will be a haunting shadow in disguise as a friend, and her strength could bring her demise."

Lots of good nuggets in here!

Iradel plucked a slip of paper the size of a notecard from his stack and slid it partway across the desk. But his hand didn't lift from it. I looked up to meet his eyes.

Something in them had shifted — the way the sky settles before weather changes.

His tone was hushed but resolved.

"As you know," he said, his tone quieter than before, "I do not make mistakes in my placements."

I waited. He didn't continue right away, and the pause stretched longer than any pause I had known him to leave.

"I never promise an easy assignment, but I promise one that is worth it," he said.

I glanced at Deets. He had gone very still.

"What do you mean?" The question had left me before I decided to ask it. Iradel's expression didn't change. His shoulders were still lifted, his eyes still warm. But something underneath all of it had gone solemn.

"You will be met with great challenge, but I would not give it to you if I didn't believe you were equal to it."

He released the paper. I picked it up.

*After writing
this scene, I
now celebrate
my "Birthday
Eve"*



It was now real. We would be back on Earth in less than twenty-four hours.

THE STORY CONTINUES

Thank you for reading! Time is precious, and I'm honored you spent part of your day exploring a world I've devoted so much of my life to.



If this glimpse pulled you in, pick up the full novel. Release date: December 2026..

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